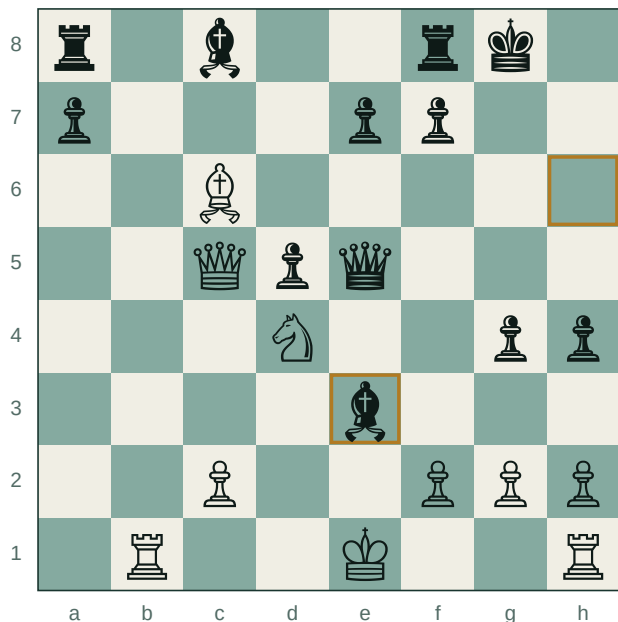


Active defensive resources: White, move 24

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 23...Bxe3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

24. fxe3 Qxe3+ 25. Kd1

24.fxe3 The pawn captures the bishop on e3. Recorded reply: **24...Qxe3+**.

25.Kd1 The king moves from e1 to d1.

At the end, nominal material is White 28 / Black 28 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +2: the balance goes from -2 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8 and queen on e5. Check for tactical protection.